

and effective. "I like his directness," Hardeman says. "Up front, Baker states his name, the company he represents, and that it specializes in men's custom clothing. Unlike a lot of salesmen, he doesn't beat around the bush."

"He does what I used to do when I first got started in the insurance business," Gandolfo says. "I represented a company called Kennesaw Life Insurance Company, and after I'd introduce myself, I'd say, 'I'm sure you're familiar with Kennesaw Life.' Most people automatically nod their heads in agreement, especially when a salesperson's head is bobbing up and down. Now, I know that the vast majority of people never heard of the company, but by the way I said it, they thought they were *supposed* to know who Kennesaw was."

Gandolfo also likes Baker's appearance and the fact that he wears a Winchester suit. "It's a big mistake for a salesperson not to use the product he sells," the insurance agent states. "It's paramount to a Mercedes salesman driving a Caddy or a Chevy. Unless you believe in your product one hundred percent, you're simply not going to be effective. And I'll tell you something. Before I owned a million dollars of life insurance, I couldn't sell a million-dollar policy because I couldn't understand how anyone could afford so much coverage. Once I was insured for a million, and several more later on, I had the conviction to convince others that they, too, should be insured for those amounts. People sense this kind of conviction the very moment a salesman opens his mouth—whether he's in the same room or on the telephone."

Gandolfo, Shafiroff, and Rodgers are strong advocates of "concept selling" and like the way Baker tells the prospect, "I would like to share an idea with you." Gandolfo, for instance, initially tells a prospect, "I'm in the insurance and tax-shelter business, and I'm assuming that you pay more than four thousand dollars a year in taxes, personal or corporate. If so, you're paying too much and I'd like to run some ideas by you." This statement is a big attention-getter and opens the door with Gandolfo